ShopEase Legal, Escalations & Compliance Knowledge Base (KB)

Document Owner: Legal, Compliance & Grievance Redressal Team

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Classification: Internal Confidential

1. Escalation Matrix and Response SLAs

ShopEase follows a strict three-tier escalation matrix to ensure timely resolution of customer issues in accordance with Indian e-commerce regulations.

1.1 Support Levels & SLAs

- **Tier 1 (Frontline Support):** Handles general queries (Where is my order, basic returns).
  - *First Response SLA:* 2 hours.
  - *Resolution SLA:* 24-48 business hours.
- **Tier 2 (Escalation Desk):** Handles breached SLAs, deadlocked buyer-seller disputes, and compensation requests.
  - *First Response SLA:* 12 hours.
  - *Resolution SLA:* 72 business hours.
- **Tier 3 (Grievance Redressal Mechanism):** Handles legal threats, privacy breaches, consumer court notices, and unresolved Tier 2 tickets.
  - *Acknowledgment SLA:* 48 hours (Mandated by law).
  - *Resolution SLA:* Maximum 30 days from receipt of the complaint.

2. Formal Complaint & Grievance Redressal Process

2.1 How Customers Can File a Formal Complaint

If a customer is dissatisfied with Tier 1 and Tier 2 resolutions, they have the right to escalate the issue formally.

1. **Grievance Portal:** Customers must log in and navigate to My Account > Help Center > Escalate to Grievance Officer.
2. **Email Initiation:** Alternatively, customers can email the dedicated grievance desk directly with their Ticket ID.

2.2 Grievance Officer Details (Statutory Requirement)

Under the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020, ShopEase has appointed a resident Grievance Officer.

- **Name:** Mr. Rohan Sharma

- **Designation:** Chief Grievance Officer (CGO)
- **Email:** grievance.officer@shopease.in
- **Postal Address:** ShopEase Headquarters, Block C, Tech Park, Outer Ring Road, Bengaluru, Karnataka, 560103.
- **Phone:** 080-XXXX-XXXX (Available Mon-Fri, 9 AM - 6 PM IST)

Agent Action: Agents must provide these details immediately and without hesitation if a customer explicitly asks for the Grievance Officer's contact information.

3. Legal Rights & Regulatory Applicability

3.1 Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (CPA)

ShopEase strictly complies with the CPA 2019 and the E-Commerce Rules of 2020.

- **Unfair Trade Practices:** ShopEase and its sellers cannot manipulate prices, refuse legitimate returns within the stated window, or post fake reviews.
- **National Consumer Helpline (NCH):** Customers have the right to register complaints on the INGRAM (Integrated Grievance Redressal Mechanism) portal. If ShopEase receives a notice from NCH, the Legal Desk must resolve it within **15 days**.
- **Consumer Courts (NCDRC/SCDRC/DCDRC):** Customers can file cases in the District, State, or National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions. Any notice received from a

consumer forum must be immediately routed to legalnotices@shopease.in.

3.2 RERA Applicability (Clarification)

- **Definition:** RERA stands for the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016.
- **Applicability to ShopEase: RERA is NOT applicable to ShopEase.** RERA strictly governs the real estate sector (builders, promoters, real estate agents). Because ShopEase is an e-commerce retail marketplace dealing in movable goods and standard services, RERA laws do not apply to any transactions on our platform.
- **Agent Action:** If a customer confusingly cites RERA for a delayed product delivery, agents should politely clarify: *"Sir/Ma'am, RERA governs real estate transactions. Your purchase is protected under the Consumer Protection Act 2019, and we will resolve your issue under these guidelines."*

4. Compensation and Goodwill Policy

Goodwill gestures are not a legal right but a customer retention tool used to apologize for platform or logistical failures.

4.1 Policy for Delayed Orders

If a prepaid or high-value order is delayed past the original promised delivery date (EDD):

- **Delay of 1-3 Days:** Apology email; expedite request raised with 3PL. No compensation. ● **Delay of 4-7 Days:** Agent is empowered to issue a **₹100 to ₹250 ShopEase Wallet Credit**.

- **Delay > 7 Days or Missed Special Event (e.g., Birthday):** Agent can issue a **10% discount coupon (up to ₹500)** for their next purchase + Wallet Credit.

4.2 Goodwill Gestures (Coupons & Credits)

- **Usage Limit:** An agent can issue a maximum of ₹500 in goodwill per customer per rolling 6-month period without manager approval.
- **Form of Goodwill:** Always prioritize ShopEase Wallet Credits (which lock the money into the ecosystem) over direct bank refunds, unless resolving a specific billing error.
- **Exclusions:** Never issue goodwill for delays caused by force majeure (floods, curfews, strikes) or if the customer has a history of policy abuse.

5. Data Privacy and DPDP Act 2023 Compliance

ShopEase strictly adheres to the **Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023**. We act as a "Data Fiduciary," and our customers are "Data Principals."

5.1 Customer Rights under DPDP

1. **Right to Access:** Customers can request a summary of the personal data ShopEase holds. Agents route these to the Privacy Desk, fulfilling them within 72 hours.
2. **Right to Correction:** Customers can edit their addresses, names, and numbers directly in the app.
3. **Right to Erasure (Right to be Forgotten):** Customers can request permanent deletion of their account and data.

5.2 Processing Data Deletion Requests

- **Initiation:** Customer submits a deletion request via the Privacy Center in the app.
- **Cooling Period:** The account is suspended for 30 days. During this time, the customer can log back in to cancel the deletion.
- **Execution:** After 30 days, all PII (Personally Identifiable Information) is anonymized.
- **Exceptions:** Under the DPDP Act and taxation laws, ShopEase is legally required to retain transaction/invoice data (which includes the shipping address and name) for **7 years** for GST and audit purposes. Agents must explain this if a customer demands absolute erasure of their purchase history.

6. Account Suspension and Ban Policy

To maintain a safe marketplace, ShopEase actively monitors customer accounts for fraudulent behavior.

6.1 Grounds for Account Suspension

- **Wardrobing/High Returns:** Returning more than 70% of purchased items across 15+ orders (especially in the Fashion category).
- **Return Fraud:** Sending back empty boxes, counterfeit replacements, or used/damaged items.

- **Abuse of Staff:** Using abusive, racist, or threatening language with delivery executives or support agents.
- **Promo Abuse:** Creating multiple accounts to farm "New User" discount codes.
- **Payment Fraud:** Unusually high frequency of chargebacks or using stolen credit cards.

6.2 Suspension Process & Appeals

1. **Automated Flagging:** The Trust & Safety AI flags the account and places a temporary lock.
2. **Notification:** The customer receives an email stating their account privileges have been restricted due to policy violations.
3. **Appeal Process:** The customer has 30 days to reply to the email with an explanation.
4. **Final Decision:** A human Trust & Safety analyst reviews the appeal. If rejected, the account, phone number, and associated device ID are permanently blacklisted (Hard Ban).
   Agents cannot overturn a T&S Hard Ban under any circumstances.